Japan Machinery: Automation: Trade statistics: August 2026 robot/Robodrill volume inferred from customs data

The Ministry of Finance announced trade data for August 2026 during morning trading on September 29. We use this data as an indicator of volume trends for Fanuc's (Sell) robots and Robodrill No. 30 vertical machining centers, and Yaskawa Electric's (Buy) robots. Japanese companies have a large share of the global robot market and high domestic production ratios. Since Japan accounts for the majority of global robot production, we believe export volume trends from Japan to the rest of the world can be viewed as an indicator of investment in robots and automation, mainly in the auto and electronics industries. In this note, we outline our views on the robot industry and casing demand trends inferred from this month's data.

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Exhibit 1: Robots: Trade statistics summary

Robot: Japan	N. America	Europe	China	Global
Volume	**1,822**	**1,492**	**4,294**	**10,942**
yoy	6%	46%	-21%	7%
mom	-20%	7%	-24%	-10%
Value (¥mn)	**5,205**	**4,244**	**7,020**	**21,947**
yoy	11%	63%	-19%	10%
mom	-23%	15%	-20%	-8%
ASP (¥mn)	**2.86**	**2.84**	**1.63**	**2.01**
yoy	5%	12%	2%	2%
mom	-4%	8%	5%	3%

Robot: Fanuc (GSE)	N. America	Europe	China	Global
Volume	**1,433**	**1,238**	**2,523**	**6,417**
yoy	2%	73%	-31%	-2%
mom	-23%	25%	-27%	-13%
Value (¥mn)	**4,402**	**3,778**	**4,574**	**15,473**
yoy	2%	94%	-36%	1%
mom	-26%	31%	-30%	-12%
ASP (¥mn)	**3.07**	**3.05**	**1.81**	**2.41**
yoy	0%	12%	-7%	2%
mom	-4%	5%	-4%	2%

Source: Ministry of Finance, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Robodrills: Trade statistics summary

Robodrill: Japan	Asia	China	AeCJ	Global
Volume	**1,695**	**1,110**	**585**	**1,785**
yoy	40%	73%	3%	38%
mom	0%	12%	-16%	1%
Value (¥mn)	**11,634**	**6,800**	**4,834**	**13,111**
yoy	32%	41%	21%	28%
mom	-2%	9%	-14%	-6%
ASP (¥mn)	**6.86**	**6.13**	**8.26**	**7.34**
yoy	-6%	-18%	18%	-7%
mom	-2%	-2%	2%	-7%

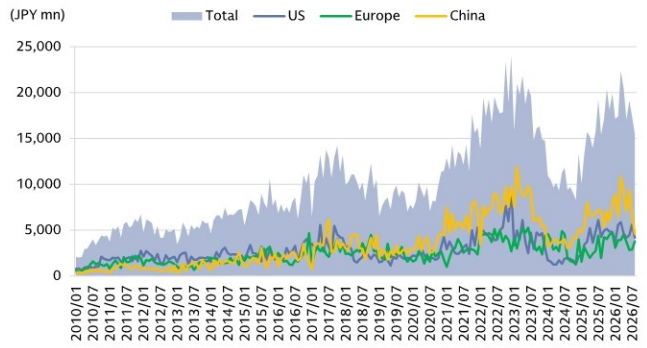
Robodrill: Fanuc (GSE)	Asia	China	AeCJ	Global
Volume	**1,279**	**968**	**311**	**1,283**
yoy	64%	138%	-17%	62%
mom	5%	23%	-27%	5%
Value (¥mn)	**7,257**	**5,244**	**2,012**	**7,325**
yoy	28%	63%	-18%	28%
mom	3%	17%	-21%	3%
ASP (¥mn)	**5.67**	**5.42**	**6.47**	**5.71**
yoy	-22%	-31%	-2%	-21%
mom	-2%	-5%	8%	-2%

Source: Ministry of Finance, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Robot export volume (Fanuc, Yaskawa Electric, and Japan total)

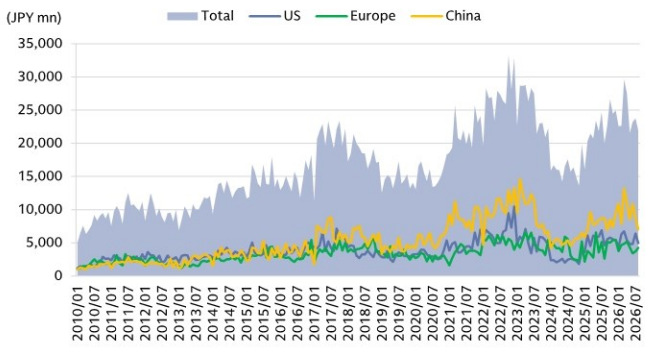
- **Fanuc (global exports from the two Kanto ports in August: 6,417 units, -2% yoy/-13% mom):** We estimate that Fanuc robots made at its Yamanashi main plant and its Tsukuba plant account for the bulk of exports from the two Kanto ports. In its FY3/27 Q1 results, Fanuc confirmed that order intake had continued to exceed sales, and we estimate that its order backlog remains at a high level. However, we believe the yoy and mom declines in export volume reflect the production constraints also confirmed in the Q1 results. The company has stated that these production constraints relate to controllers and their components, and we assume robots are also affected by these constraints. Alternatively, this could reflect production allocation decisions within the company's product portfolio, such as whether Fanuc is prioritizing controller shipments for CNC products over those for robots. We will continue to monitor trends going forward.
- **Yaskawa Electric (global exports from Moji in August: 901 units, +27% yoy/+13% mom):** Yaskawa Electric is the only major robot maker with a production base in Kyushu, and we therefore believe its robots account for the majority of export volume from the port of Moji. Exports totaled 1,309 units in April (+35% yoy), 347 units in May (-54% yoy), 83 units in June (-92% yoy), 795 units in July (-12% yoy), and 901 units in August (+27% yoy), suggesting that production and shipment delays caused by the ERP system transition are gradually improving (see our update on production trends: LINK). We will continue to monitor trends going forward.

Exhibit 3: Fanuc: Robot shipment value by destination (GSe)



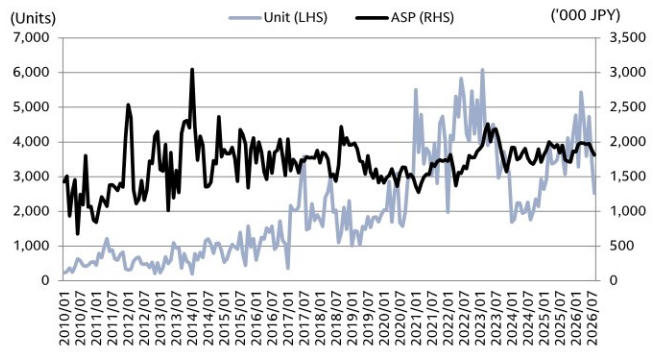
Source: Ministry of Finance, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: Japan: Robot shipment value by destination



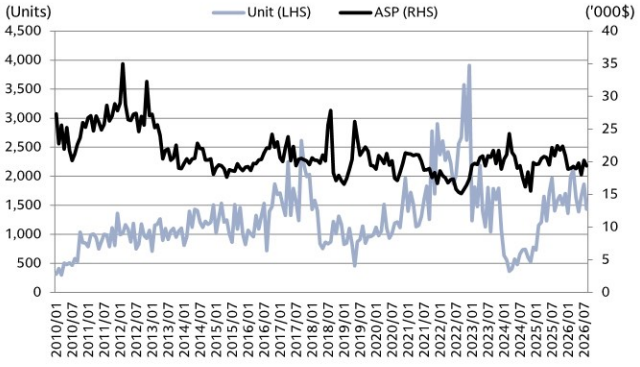
Source: Ministry of Finance, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: Fanuc: Robot export volume to China and average export price (GSe)



Source: Ministry of Finance, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 6: Fanuc: Robot export volume to North America and average export price (GSe)

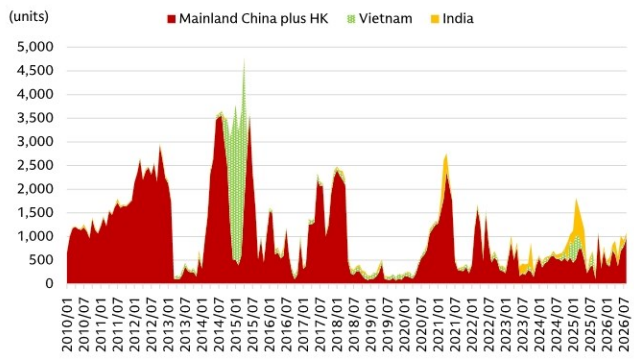


Source: Ministry of Finance, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Vertical machining center export volume from the two Kanto ports (assumes Fanuc accounts for the majority of export volume)

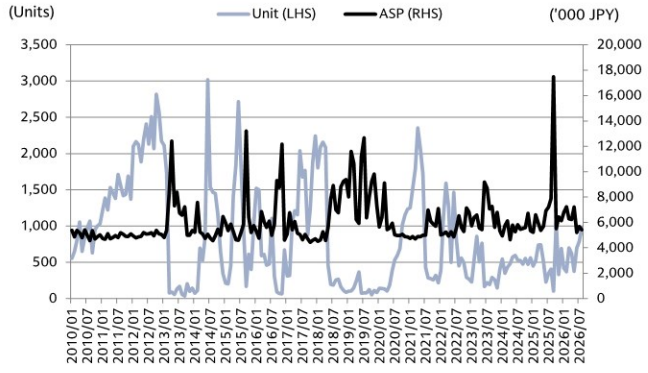
- **Fanuc:** We estimate that Robodrills made at Fanuc's Tsukuba plant account for the bulk of the No. 30 vertical machining centers exported from the two Kanto ports. Of these, 968 units were shipped to mainland China, a solid performance (+138% yoy/+23% mom). By contrast, exports to India totaled 69 units (+138% yoy/+10% mom) and exports to Vietnam totaled 44 units (-83% yoy/-36% mom), with momentum for these markets appearing weak.

Exhibit 7: Fanuc: Breakdown of Robodrill export volume by region (GSe)



Source: Ministry of Finance, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 8: Fanuc: Robodrill export volume to China and average export price (GSe)



Source: Ministry of Finance, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Yaskawa Electric (6506.T)

Our 12-month target price of ¥5,500 is based on FY2/28E-FY2/29E EV/EBITDA, applying the sector-average multiple of 9X and a 30% sector-relative premium.

Key downside risks include (1) a slowdown in semiconductor and AI Capex related business, (2) slower-than-expected results from cost optimization measures, and (3) slower than expected recovery from its ERP issues.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Fanuc (6954.T)

Our 12-month target price of ¥4,600 is based on FY3/28E-FY3/29E EV/EBITDA, applying the sector-average multiple of 9X and a 60% sector-relative premium.

Key upside risks include sales in the FA business recovering to levels above past peaks, greater-than-expected improvement in robot business margins, and share buybacks or other moves to strengthen shareholder returns.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Yuichiro Isayama and Takato Enoki, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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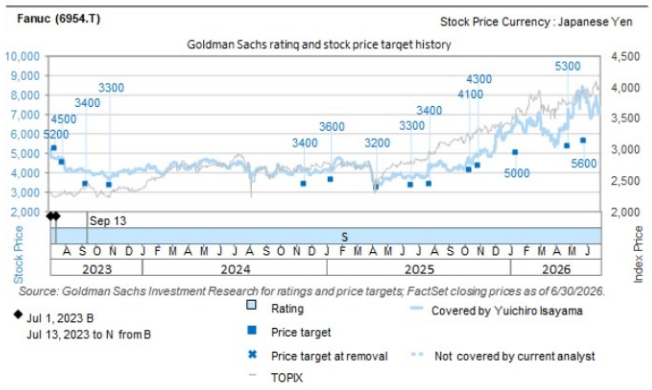
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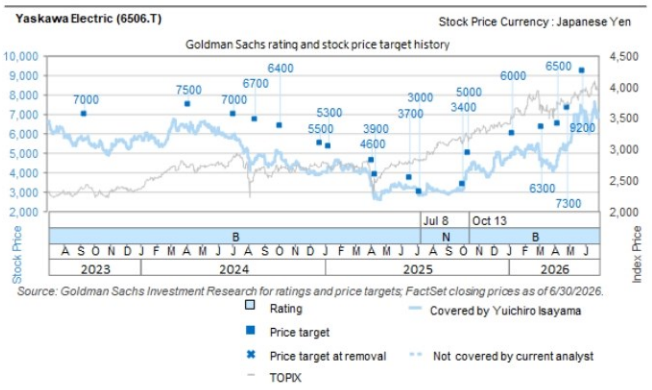
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	Buy	Hold	Sell	Buy	Hold	Sell
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Target price history table(s)

Fanuc (6954.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
24-Sep-26	4,600	6,021
28-May-26	5,600	7,984
26-Apr-26	5,300	6,256
14-Jan-26	5,000	6,935
31-Oct-25	4,300	4,909
13-Oct-25	4,100	4,780
25-Jul-25	3,400	4,220
20-Jun-25	3,300	3,713
11-Apr-25	3,200	3,388
12-Jan-25	3,600	4,116
19-Nov-24	3,400	4,099
31-Oct-23	3,300	3,653

Yaskawa Electric (6506.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
24-Sep-26	5,500	4,507
13-Jul-26	9,000	5,972
28-May-26	9,200	7,136
29-Apr-26	7,300	5,381
10-Apr-26	6,500	4,894
09-Mar-26	6,300	4,325
09-Jan-26	6,000	5,026
13-Oct-25	5,000	4,085
03-Oct-25	3,400	3,178
08-Jul-25	3,000	2,833
20-Jun-25	3,700	3,190
11-Apr-25	3,900	2,881
06-Apr-25	4,600	3,344
10-Jan-25	5,300	4,271
24-Dec-24	5,500	3,950
04-Oct-24	6,400	5,023
16-Aug-24	6,700	4,796
05-Jul-24	7,000	5,972
05-Apr-24	7,500	6,174

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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